For brands preparing to export from Korea

Made only for export? Your CFS may be blocked

China, Vietnam and Indonesia require proof of domestic sales in Korea

Buyer's country	Proof of Korean sales
China · Vietnam · Indonesia	Required
Other countries	Check by country

Check before your first production run →

Easy to miss

In Korea, a CFS is called a 'Certificate of Manufacture and Sale.' But

When a buyer requests a CFS (Certificate of Free Sale), the Korea Cosmetic Association (KCA) advises applying for its **Certificate of Manufacture and Sale**.

KCA names **China, Vietnam and Indonesia** as countries that require proof of sales in Korea. For China, **only cosmetics that have been sold in Korea** are eligible. The proof is a transaction statement and a tax invoice.

An export-only product never sold in Korea may not get a certificate for these three countries right away.

Source: Korea Cosmetic Association (KCA), certificate issuance FAQ

One more thing

One address can stop the certificate

Addresses you can use

- Address on your manufacturer registration certificate
- Address on your responsible-seller registration certificate

Addresses you cannot use

- Address on your business registration
- Address printed on the product carton

If you moved offices without updating your registration certificate, the application stops here.

Source: Korea Cosmetic Association (KCA), certificate issuance FAQ

Documents buyers request all at once

Where you usually get them

Document	Usually from	Check
CFS	KCA (Certificate of Manufacture and Sale)	Proof of Korean sales for the 3 countries
CoA (certificate of analysis)	Manufacturer	Per production lot
MSDS	Manufacturer	Per product
INCI ingredient list	Based on the manufacturer's formula	English ingredient names
GMP certificate	Manufacturer	Copy

Typical cases · may vary by contract, so check with your manufacturer first

The day the email arrives

Three things to do today

1. **Check the buyer's country first**
   For China, Vietnam or Indonesia, check that you have proof of sales in Korea

2. **Check your registration certificate address**
   Does it match your current office address?

3. **Ask your manufacturer all at once**
   Request the CoA, MSDS and INCI list together, confirm when they can be provided, then tell the buyer

> If you are planning an export-only product, check **before your first production run** whether these three countries are among your target markets.
> Next post: additional documents by country